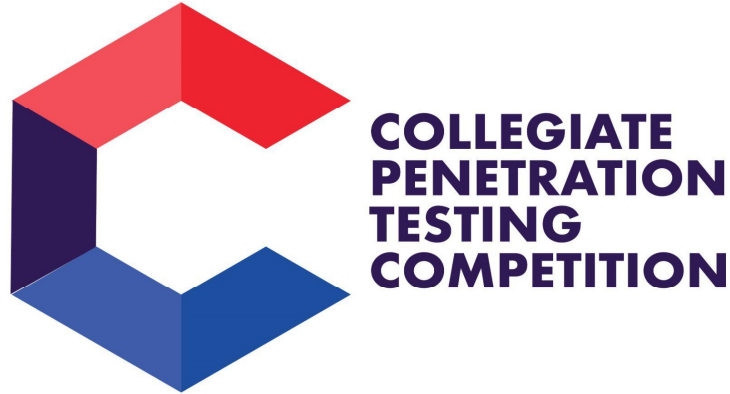




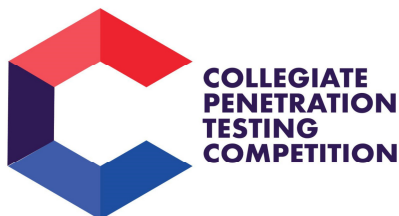
Welcome Packet

Western Regional

Global Collegiate Penetration Testing Competition

November 8-9, 2025

Revision: 1.4, 2025-10-24



Welcome to the 11th season of the Global Collegiate Penetration Testing Competition! It is exciting to have seen this event grow over the past decade into what you are experiencing today. We are looking forward to an awesome weekend!

This weekend's event is the culmination of thousands of hours of collaboration and effort by our team, creating an experience that will challenge you while also creating an opportunity furthering your education beyond what you'll see in a typical classroom setting.

As you compete this weekend, take the time to meet with our dedicated teams of volunteers, industry professionals, and sponsors who work to make this event a success, as well as the students on teams from other universities. The faces you see here will be your peers in industry for many years to come.

We'd also like to take the time to personally thank the members of your regional hosting institution who have spent so much time over the past several months planning this event and making it possible. Without their hard work behind the scenes, this event would not have been possible.

Our goal throughout this event is education: while only one team will be declared the winner, the most valuable experience from this event is not the final placement of teams but the experience you will gain. While it's easy to get caught up in the moment of the competition, we encourage you to look beyond that. If you have suggestions on what we can do to improve the event, please let us know - we are always looking for feedback and ways we can make the event even better.

In the event of an urgent issue, please contact regional hosts Alex Keller (415-608-0811) or Kerrie Lu (415-632-6700). These phone numbers are out of character and for urgent use only.

Thank you for your dedication and everything you do, we're looking forward to a great weekend!

- The CPTC Volunteers

Premiere Sponsor



IBM Security

Gold Partner



Silver Partners



Bronze Partners



Supporters



Individual Supporters:

Stuart Morris, Raul Martinez, Austin Kanarr, Lucas Morris, Meredith Kasper

Regional Sponsors



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Schedule

Regional Time Zone: PST (Pacific Standard Time)

Day	Time	Location	Activity
SATURDAY November 8			
Sat (11/8)	9:00am	Huang Engineering Basement	Teams expected on-site / Team registration / Breakfast available
Sat (11/8)	9:15am	Huang Engineering Basement	Regional welcome remarks
Sat (11/8)	9:30-9:50am	Huang Engineering Basement	Introduction presentation by CPTC Organizers
Sat (11/8)	9:50-10:00am	Team Competition Rooms	Teams released to their assigned rooms
Sat (11/8)	10:00am	Team Competition Rooms	Assessment phase begins
Sat (11/8)	12:30-1:30pm	Huang Engineering Basement	Lunch available
Sat (11/8)	6:00pm	Team Competition Rooms	Access to competition environment ends
Sat (11/8)	6:15pm	Huang Engineering Basement	Evening close-out presentation / Dinner available
Sat (11/8)	11:59pm	Teams may adjourn to wherever they prefer. Huang Engineering basement will remain available.	Reports due
SUNDAY October/November XX			
Sun (11/9)	10:45am	Shriram 108	Teams expected on-site / Brunch available
Sun (11/9)	Noon	Shriram 104	Keynote speaker / Sponsor presentations
Sun (11/9)	1:00pm	Shriram 104	Global CPTC Directors' comments + Q&A
Sun (11/9)	2:00pm	Shriram 104	Awards presentations & closing remarks
Sun (11/9)	2:30pm	Shriram 104	Competition weekend ends

***Bold** denotes an event related to scored aspects of the competitions

Team Registration

Teams are to arrive onsite at Stanford University Huang Engineering Center basement by 9am on Saturday 11/8 where CPTC representatives will be available for team registration.

We ask that all teams be available during the beginning of this window so that we can process all team check-ins as quickly and efficiently as possible.

During registration, all team members and coaches will sign an attestation acknowledging that they have read the CPTC rules and agree to abide by them during the competition weekend. Please have all team members review the latest version of the CPTC rules, available at <https://cp.tc/overview>.

All team members and the team's coach must be present for team registration and present a photo ID when checking in with the CPTC staff. A government or school issued photo ID is acceptable. If your region has badges, team members will be given their badges for the event at the time of registration, and badges **must be worn at all times** during the competition weekend. Anyone without a badge will not be permitted to enter competition areas, including team rooms and meals.

Competition Attire

To help eliminate any potential scoring biases during the event, teams should not wear any attire during scored events that identifies their school or institution.

Examples of when identifying attire may NOT be worn:

- During the on-site assessment phase of the competition (e.g., any time on campus on Saturday)

Examples of when identifying attire is acceptable:

- The awards ceremony on Sunday afternoon
- Outside of competition hours (e.g., Saturday night after 6:15pm)

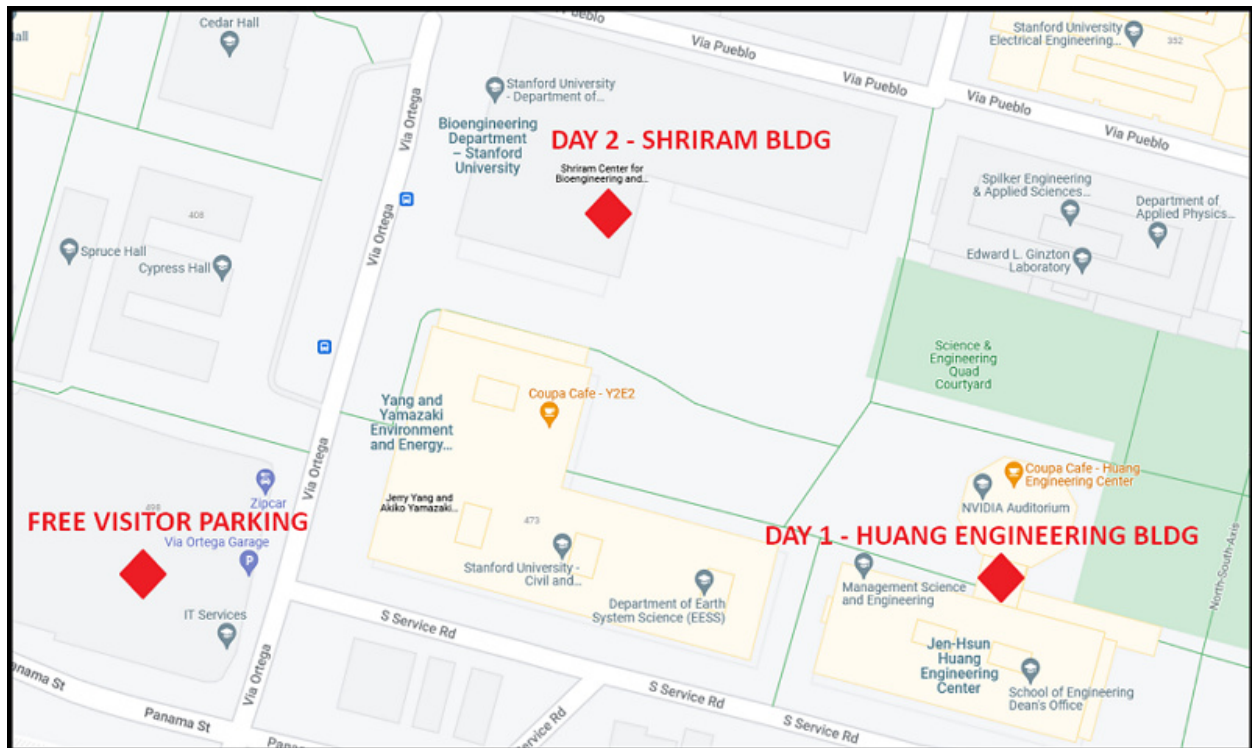
Campus Maps & Parking

Location: Stanford University, Science & Engineering Quad

Free Visitor Parking (Sat/Sun): Via Ortega Garage, 498 Via Ortega, Stanford, CA (Google Map: <https://goo.gl/maps/DTBvvp99QJ9drJ5Q7>)

Saturday: Huang Engineering Basement, 475 Via Ortega, Stanford, CA

Sunday: Shriram Building Room 104/108, 443 Via Ortega, Stanford, CA



Support

Teams looking to communicate with client staff should enter a ticket at <https://support.cp.tc>.

Rules

The CPTC rules are available here: <https://cp.tc/overview>

The official CPTC rules were last updated in **August, 2024**. Please disregard any previous versions of the rules you may have available.

Urgent Contact Number

In the event of an urgent issue, please contact regional hosts Alex Keller (415-608-0811) or Kerrie Lu (415-632-6700). These phone numbers are out of character and for urgent use only.



About the Client – All Ports Tours (APT)

All Ports Tours, the parent company of Croissant Cruises, is a mid-sized cruise operator that prides itself on delivering “Sunsets as a Service” to its passengers. The brand emphasizes modern, semi-autonomous cruise experiences where guests enjoy seamless entertainment, luxury amenities, and efficient operations while much of the ship’s navigation and core control systems are coordinated remotely from corporate Headquarters (HQ).

Following the economic downturn during the COVID-19 pandemic, the company reduced its investment in security assessments. As a result, Croissant Cruises has not undergone a penetration test in over five years. In that time, the fleet has adopted more automation, consolidated IT operations, and expanded remote command-and-control capabilities. This evolution raises the stakes for cybersecurity, making it critical to validate the resiliency of the current systems.

Organizational IT Structure

Onboard (ship-level, low-level IT staff)

- Ship IT Support Staff: Handle day-to-day troubleshooting for crew laptops, printers, POS systems, and passenger Wi-Fi. Often understaffed and juggling multiple responsibilities.
- Communications Technician: Maintains satellite communications (VSAT) and network equipment onboard. Sometimes defers patching due to operational demands.
- Bridge Operators / Technical Crew: Non-specialist crew who interact with navigation consoles and diagnostic tools. Provide valuable operational support but limited in cybersecurity expertise.

Onshore (HQ, high-level IT team)

- CISO & Cybersecurity Office: Define policies, approve engagements, and own risk.
- Fleet Operations Center: Remote operators who issue commands to autonomous systems and monitor ship telemetry.
- Corporate IT / DevOps Team: Maintain the Fleet Control Platform, cloud services, and centralized identity infrastructure.
- SOC/NOC Teams: Monitor logs from both HQ and the ships, providing centralized detection and response.

This structure creates a natural division: shipboard staff act as the first line of troubleshooting, while HQ IT provides centralized oversight and strategic security management.

Penetration Test Goals

- Validate control channel security between HQ and the semi-autonomous vessels — preventing spoofed commands or telemetry manipulation.
- Test network segmentation onboard (guest Wi-Fi, crew VLAN, operational technology) to confirm isolation of critical systems.
- Review update pipelines for the Fleet Control Platform and onboard systems to ensure protection against malicious updates.
- Assess identity and access management for shipboard IT staff and HQ administrators, focusing on credential theft and privilege escalation risks.
- Evaluate incident detection and response — can the SOC detect, investigate, and respond effectively to onboard-originating intrusions?
- Test resilience to social engineering (targeted phishing simulations for selected ship and HQ staff).

Out of Scope

- Third-party vendor systems such as bars, restaurants, and entertainment platforms are excluded from testing.
- Any live testing that could disrupt passenger safety, propulsion, or navigation during voyages is strictly prohibited.

Out-of-Scope Networks

- VDI
- VPN
- RIT Cyber Range
- Regional Host/University Environment

Out-of-Scope Tools

- Our Technology Partner's Deployment Tool (LaForge)
- Our Managed Security Service Provider's Log Collection Agent (SplunkUniversalForwarder)

The Challenge for Croissant Cruises

The brand's identity, "Sunsets as a Service", highlights its commitment to creating memorable guest experiences. But this slogan now carries an ironic double meaning: ensuring that sunsets remain an amenity for passengers — not the result of a catastrophic security failure.

By testing both shipboard weaknesses (limited IT staff, high workload, inconsistent patching) and HQ-level risks (remote control platforms, SOC visibility), this engagement aims to bring Croissant Cruises back into a mature, defensible cybersecurity posture fit for a modern autonomous fleet.

Environment Access

All access to VDI systems will be direct into All Ports Tours' environment through Microsoft RDP. We have created a virtual desktop for each of your employees so that you do not have to share systems. You will be able to RDP directly to the six Windows systems created for you. There are an additional six Unix systems that have been created in this environment for your use as well. Note that you must access the Unix systems via SSH from the Windows VDI hosts, and they do NOT have a GUI installed.

Reminder: The VDI subnet is NOT in scope for the assessment.

Regional-Specific Access Information

All team competition rooms will include table, chairs, whiteboard, and sufficient power receptacles.

Active competitors must bring their own laptops for the competition. External monitors and keyboards are allowed, any other peripherals need to be explicitly approved by the competition hosts/organizers.

Teams are required to submit the WiFi MAC addresses for their 6 active competitors in advance via the CPTC WEST 2025 Pre-Competition Team Survey (<https://forms.gle/QNZTRaU1cNA7ST967>), one survey submission per team please.

Microsoft Office 365

All teams will be provisioned with an Office 365 account for use during the event. The credentials for these accounts will be available in the <https://scoring.cp.tc> portal at the start of the assessment phase of the engagement. There is a shared folder in OneDrive for storing sensitive documentation. An authenticated form for submitting the final report and presentation deliverables to the All Ports Tours team will be available for submission.

This drive is the ONLY place All Ports Tours permits data and artifacts related to this security assessment to be stored by the security assessment team. You are to perform all work during the assessment phase of the assessment within the VDI environment and using the provided Office 365 account for any document storage. Third party services may not contain any All Ports Tours data.

We also ask that you protect our data similar to that of your other clients and not take large volumes of information from our environments, as we would consider that a breach. A link to the submission form is in your email inbox.

Reporting Requirements

Reports will be submitted to the Microsoft Form shared with each team. Deliverables must be submitted before the deadline of **11:59pm PT on Saturday, November 8th, 2025.**

Reporting requirements

- All deliverables must be All Ports Tours Branded.
- Reference who you are by Team # and region (ex: Western-1).
- No mentions of firm or institution name are permitted.
- All team reports for this event may be publicly released after the competition.
- Teams should submit two copies of their report - one for scoring (PDF), one editable file (MS Word or equivalent) for our team to edit/redact for public release. The content of both files must otherwise be identical.

Example reports from previous events are available here:

https://github.com/nationalcptc/report_examples

Sharing your experience

Our goal throughout this event is education, and we encourage you to share information after the event to let the world know about your experience, what your team did, and what other teams can do to be better in the future. If your team writes any blog posts about the event, let us know, and we'll share them via the official CPTC LinkedIn account!

The Competition non-disclosure agreement (NDA) will be in effect until the close of the awards ceremony for the CPTC11 Global Finals in January, 2026 – this is to ensure fairness across all regions and ensure teams competing after your event will not have an unfair advantage. Upon the completion of the event, you are welcome and encouraged to share your experience with others.

Winners, WildCards, and Feedback

The top placing team at each of the 7 regional events will earn the opportunity to compete at the CPTC11 Global Finals held at RIT in January, 2026 (January 9-11). Teams that don't place first will still have the opportunity to compete in the Global Finals through our wildcard scoring process, where the next 5 top teams overall will also earn the right to participate.

Wildcard announcements will happen after the conclusion of all regional events. We anticipate making these announcements via livestream during the week of November 24th, 2025. Teams that earn the right to participate in Global Finals must submit a statement of intent to participate within 5 calendar days of the wildcard announcement to allow time for travel arrangements.

Failure to confirm this acceptance within this timeframe will result in a forfeiture of your team's Global Finals berth.

Due to rising travel costs in the CPTC11 competition season, we are not able to provide full travel sponsorships to most of the 12 schools who will attend Global Finals. That said, we *will not* charge competitors for attendance and *will* be able to provide all meals and hotel accommodations. There *will* be a small pool of sponsorship funds available to defray costs for teams traveling to finals who have exceptional need. Further detail will be available once we have identified the top 12 schools and any alternates.

We will also make scoring feedback available in the <https://scoring.cp.tc> portal shortly after the wildcard announcements.

Look for more details to come after the event!